Each Life, Its Own Mountain and River
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Each Life, Its Own Mountain and River

On the quiet dignity of different paths

BUDDHIST PHILOSOPHY
JUL 1



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I don’t know how heavy the rain you’ve walked through, so I have no right to question why your clothes are soaked.

I don’t know who you’ve loved, so I cannot judge why you’ve become so guarded toward love.

I haven’t seen the muddy roads you’ve trudged, so I won’t criticize the cautious steadiness of your steps.

I haven’t endured the long, lonely nights you’ve survived, so I cannot mock your preference for silence and solitude.

Every life is its own vast mountain and sea. We are born into different fires, raised under different skies. The storms we’ve witnessed vary, and the warmth and cold we carry in our hearts are never the same.

Some are surrounded by flowers from birth — gentle and open, never knowing the bite of frost. Others grow up dancing with the wind and rain — learning to hold their own umbrella, quietly hiding their scars.

In this world, no two lives perfectly align. Between people lie gaps of experience, circumstance, and perspective. You don't understand my helplessness, and I don't understand your ease. You haven't known my wanderings and hardships, and I haven't known your calm and grace.

We too often measure others by our own ruler, judging their choices through the lens of our own fortune. Yet behind every seemingly stubborn persistence, every apparent cowardice, every distant silence, there are untold stories and unavoidable burdens.

There is no need to sneer at another's humility, to criticize their decisions, or to demand they live in the shape we prefer. Blooming has its brilliance; wilderness has its own quiet peace. Passion is one way to live — stillness is another worthy path.

True gentleness is knowing how uneven the world is, yet choosing to remain open-hearted. It is understanding that everyone carries their own suffering, and therefore refusing to judge lightly.

The best way to walk alongside one another is not to demand identical views or matching steps, but to acknowledge our differences and offer mutual respect.

You have your flower-strewn path. I have my thorny trail.

We need not look up to each other, nor look down.

We simply walk our own journeys and allow the other to do the same.

With kindness in our words, clarity in our sight, acceptance of all differences, and compassion for every circumstance — this is the finest practice for the rest of our lives.



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